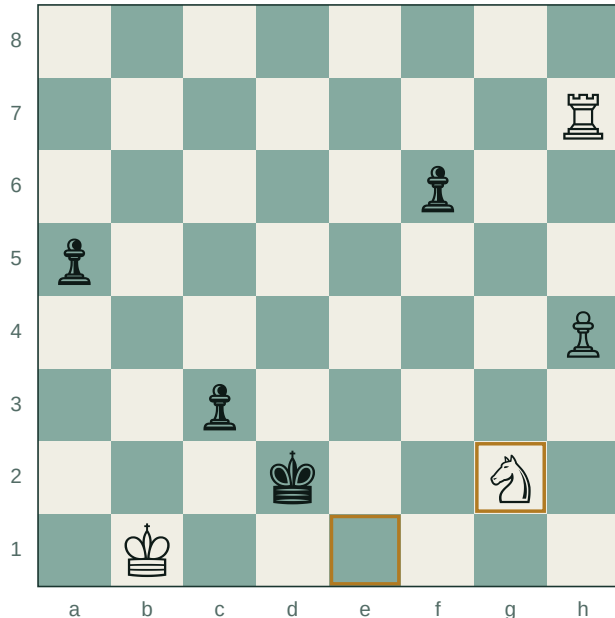


Active defensive resources: Black, move 48

Active defensive resources

Black to move



Previous move: 48.Nxg2. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

48...c2+ 49. Ka2 c1=Q 50. Rd7+ Ke2

48...c2+ Check restricts White to 3 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **49.Ka2**.

49...c1=Q The pawn moves from c2 to c1. The pawn becomes a queen. Recorded reply: **50.Rd7+**.

50...Ke2 The king moves from d2 to e2.

At the end, nominal material is White 9 / Black 11 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +8. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +8:** the balance goes from -6 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A defensive puzzle may aim to preserve equality rather than win. Judge success against the threat, not only the final material count.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

The best defense may create a threat, exchange an attacker, or change the geometry of the attack. Identify the opponent's concrete idea before selecting a response.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the threatened move and the conditions it requires. Look for a move that breaks one of those conditions with tempo.

The defending king is on b1. Geometrically undefended: rook on h7 and knight on g2. Check for tactical protection.